

government, and you'll have government-formed children. Your human capital is likely to lose value.

Education is an important part of your children's preparation. It shouldn't be left to chance or to the public school system, which has a curriculum designed to promote ideas that are often contrary to the values of successful families. Public schools teach the government's narrative, not a family's narrative. And it's the family narrative that makes up an important part of the family culture.

That doesn't mean you can't send your children to public schools. It's just that if you do, you need a parent to oversee the child's progress. You also need to provide children with more than the public schools can. Even if they do their jobs well, the schools—public or private—are providing only a small part of the training needed to succeed in life.

Remember, the real wealth of a family is not financial. The primary assets are the family members and their unique talents, knowledge, and experience. After all, if you pass along significant financial wealth without the means to manage it, it will be more of a curse than a blessing, and your family will not possess that money for long. Wealth can provide freedom, security, and opportunity for your family. Money can help family members live richer, more fulfilling lives.

But putting money into the hands of unprepared family members can have the opposite effect—it can make them less free. Instead of finding themselves with a tool they know how to use, family money can be like a chainsaw in the hands of a drunk—a danger to himself and all around him.

Family members can become dysfunctional and demotivated by receiving large amounts of unearned wealth. They can become combative and litigious. Unearned wealth often leads to strange and deleterious emotional reactions, for example, feelings of unworthiness, incompetence, and guilt.

You don't want this to happen to your children and grandchildren.